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MSCAIBUS1 / MSCAI

Innovator Critique: From Pipeline to Position

Customer Engagement and Artificial Intelligence (H9CEAI)

Lecturer: Victor del Rosal

Project/CA percentage of overall module grade:	NA
This CA requires a mandatory pass to complete this module:	NA

Before you start

Assignment length. This is a long assignment. It is not possible to complete within the time frame without the use of (agentic) AI tools.

Take time to think and reflect. Part of what is being assessed is your critical thinking connected to the use of AI tools. Albert Einstein is quoted saying: "If I had an hour to solve a problem I'd spend 55 minutes thinking about the problem and 5 minutes thinking about solutions." Copying and pasting the brief into AI will not work. The highest quality submissions will reflect that you first paused to think and reflect on the assignment, and that this would include thinking when and where to use AI and when not to use it. Reflect, and take time to think.

Treat this brief as an examination paper. Lecturer guidance is not available during this assessment. If any instruction in this brief is unclear, or if you identify an ambiguity, state the doubt explicitly in your submission and make your own reasoned decision. Your reasoning under uncertainty is part of what is being assessed.

Format and Duration

Individual, take-home assessment. Duration: approximately 2 hours, within a 4-hour submission window announced on Moodle. Complete from any location. AI tools are permitted and expected throughout. Your judgement, not your tooling, is what is being assessed. Submission is via Moodle: one briefing document, one live URL, and two commit hashes, as specified in the Submission Bundle.

Module Learning Outcomes Assessed

This assessment addresses the following module learning outcomes. On successful completion the learner will be able to:

1	Evaluate how AI is transforming customer engagement strategies, tools, and organisational capabilities.
2	Design and critique multi-agent pipelines that coordinate AI agents to solve business problems.
3	Critically assess the ethical, legal, and societal implications of deploying AI in customer-facing roles.
4	Take a defensible position on the deployment of AI-generated customer engagement artefacts, citing evidence from your own work.

Overview

You will run an AI innovation pipeline end to end, generating a full venture: a story, a research question, a problem statement, a solution, a prototype, a landing page, and an investor pitch deck. This output is your starting point, not your finished work. You will then apply a rigorous critique to your own generated artefacts, build a working alpha prototype of the offering, and take a clear investment position defended in a short written briefing. The assessment is designed so that AI accelerates the generative work while your own judgement, specificity, and defence of a position determine your mark.

Step 1: Run the Innovator Pipeline

Go to https://victordelrosal.com/ai-innovator/ and execute the output (prompt) end to end. The pipeline generates outputs in eight sequential steps, each feeding the next. You will receive your five random parameters (country, fruit, animal, action, and a fifth parameter of your choice) from the innovator interface.

Save every step's output as a separate file in a project folder, following the file structure specified by the innovator prompt (01-story.md, 02-research-question.md, 03-problem-statement.md, 04-solution-design.md, 05-prototype.md, index.html, pitch.html, 07-business-plan.md). ProjectName is the name of your solution.

Commit the full project folder to a public GitHub repository under your own account. The repository name must include your Moodle student ID (for example, x1234567-innovator-critique). Publish the repository to GitHub Pages so both index.html and pitch.html are reachable in a browser.

Record for submission: (1) the live GitHub Pages URL with both index.html and pitch.html reachable; (2) the public repository URL; (3) the initial commit hash after full publish.

Step 2: The Critique

A lead investor is impressed with your pitch and has just offered you USD 2 million seed funding on the strength of your pitch deck. Their request is that you, the founder, produce an independent, rigorous critique of what they are about to invest in. Use the Part headings exactly as written below. Every task refers to YOUR OWN specific run. Quote from your own files.

Part A: Regulatory Audit of Your Own Artefacts (25 marks)

Audit your own landing page (index.html) and pitch deck (pitch.html) for claims and features that would fail under the EU AI Act, GDPR, Irish consumer law, and any sector-specific rules triggered by your problem statement. Identify a minimum of five distinct issues. Present as a table with columns: Artefact (index.html or pitch.html), Issue, Severity (High, Medium, or Low), Quoted Offending Text (from your own files), Regulatory Basis (cite articles), Recommended Fix.

Close Part A with a regulatory risk posture paragraph of no more than 100 words, summarising your overall exposure.

Part B: Trust Transfer Audit (15 marks)

Read your landing page and pitch deck as if you were a prospective customer from your chosen target segment. Identify three specific moments in your own copy where customer trust would collapse, e.g., if the output contained errors.

For each of the three moments: quote the exact line from your own file, name the file it appears in, and explain in one sentence why trust collapses at that specific moment. This is the Trust Transfer Problem applied to your own work. Generic observations about AI and trust in general will not score here.

Part C: Conduct your own Research and Correct (15 marks)

Conduct your own research on the topic to verify the claims stated in index.html and pitch.html. Based on this new research, update both files.

Write a short report explaining what changes you made, including errors that were spotted, hallucinations, unsupported statistics, and misattributed sources.

Were these errors severe? Do they significantly alter the project and the pitch? Explain, citing filename and line.

Part D: Prototype (15 marks)

Build a prototype. Build a working version of the offering that is stated in the landing page and the pitch. Make this an alpha prototype: it must demonstrate the core value proposition in a working interaction, not a static mockup.

Commit to GitHub as prototype.html and ensure it is reachable via GitHub Pages. Record the commit hash for submission.

Part E: Business modelling (15 marks)

Your venture has just received a €2 million seed offer on the strength of the pitch and the prototype.

The lead investor asks you, directly:

- (a) ship in 90 days,
- (b) ship with named conditions, or
- (c) do not ship.

Take a position in 250 words.

To answer this you may use any combination of the following approaches. Evidence from these approaches should be cited in your 250-word position.

- (a) Create a team of technical and business advisors that will assist you in decision-making. Ensure that they stress-test the idea (not just agree with it), e.g., by asking difficult questions and surfacing dissent.
- (b) Carry out market research, including the use of simulated surveys and interviews with relevant customer personas, with sample size, recruitment logic, and question set recorded in an appendix.
- (c) Run scenario analysis: best case, base case, and worst case over 12 and 36 months, stating the assumptions that drive each scenario.
- (d) Conduct a pre-mortem: imagine the venture has failed 12 months from now, and write the short obituary that explains why. Name the three failure modes that surfaced.
- (e) Red-team the pitch: generate the toughest critique a skeptical VC, a sector regulator, and a target customer would each level at your offering, and record their strongest single objection.

If you choose ship with conditions, list the conditions and explain why each is non-negotiable. No hedging.

Part F: The Plan (15 marks)

Create detailed 90-day and 180-day plans that show how you would allocate the €2 million seed.

Each plan must include: headcount and hiring sequence, product milestones, go-to-market spend, regulatory and compliance workstreams triggered by your Part A findings, and a line-item budget that sums to the capital allocated for that period. State what you are deliberately NOT doing with the money, and why.

Submission Bundle

Submit all of the following via Moodle by the deadline.

Item	Required item
1	Briefing document (Word or PDF). Addresses Parts A to F with the Part headings exactly as specified in this brief. Tables, quoted file content, and appendices do not count toward a word budget.
2	Live GitHub Pages URL. Reachable in a browser without login, with index.html, pitch.html, and prototype.html all served.
3	Public repository URL.

Remember: while this as AI-human partnership, let your critical thinking shine! ✨

Marking Scheme Summary

Criterion	Weight
Part A: Regulatory Audit	25%
Part B: Trust Transfer Audit	15%
Part C: Research and Correct	15%
Part D: Prototype	15%
Part E: Business Modelling	15%
Part F: The Plan	15%
Total	100%

Submission Details

- The assessment must be electronically submitted via Moodle. Email submissions will not be accepted.
- No printed copy is required, please do not print.
- Please note that the lecturer cannot grant extensions. Extensions can only be granted if approved after the submission of a personal circumstances form. Please consult NCI360 or other support services for further information and to file a form if required.
- Late submissions will be penalised in accordance with NCI policy.
- All work submitted must be your own. Plagiarism, including undisclosed AI substitution that contradicts the evidence in your public repository, will be dealt with according to NCI Academic Integrity Policy.